

AUTISM AWARENESS SERIES

Two Kinds of Empathy

Two survival systems, not a deficit

#4 — The Double Empathy Problem

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Autistic people lack empathy.
That's not what's happening.

NEUROTYPICAL EMPATHY

Ambient social emotional synchronization.



Is this person ok?
Am I reading the room?

AUTISTIC EMPATHY

Active information-seeking/problem solving.



What happened?
What do you need?

**Social behavior
matters most**



**Information
matters most**



**Both sides struggle.
Neither side is broken.**



Different systems.

Same intention: to understand.



Not a deficit.
A different way of caring.

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